Caregiver Coaching SOP

1. Purpose and scope

Use caregiver coaching forms to sustain service quality, protect continuity of care, and maintain a transparent history of caregiver performance. Centralized records help identify patterns, provide support, track corrective actions, and inform consistent staffing decisions.

This procedure applies to Care Coordinators, Directors of Client Success, compliance personnel, the Administrator, and caregivers participating in coaching. It covers minor offenses, major offenses, action plans, and follow-up. Incident reporting and formal employment actions follow their separate agency procedures, including cases of abuse, neglect, and exploitation.

2. What the form is

A coaching form records a concern, supporting facts, the caregiver's response, the expected standard, corrective action, and follow-up results. Together, the forms provide a reliable history for coaching and assignment eligibility reviews.

3. Who uses it

- **Care Coordinator:** Document facts, classify the concern, discuss it with the caregiver, complete the form, and follow up. Immediately escalate detected or suspected major offenses, and third minor strikes, to the Director of Client Success. Report suspected abuse, neglect, or exploitation immediately to both the Director of Client Success and the Administrator.
- **Director of Client Success:** Coach and document cases in the same way as Care Coordinators. Serve as the escalation point and decision maker: review escalated cases, direct protective measures, determine corrective action or employment outcomes, and decide assignment eligibility when it is unclear.
- **Caregiver:** Contribute comments and context, identify barriers, review expectations, and participate in the corrective action plan.
- **Administrator:** Receive reports of suspected abuse, neglect, or exploitation directly from the Care Coordinator, at the same time as the Director of Client Success. Direct protective measures and investigations for those cases, and support the Director of Client Success and compliance personnel.
- **Compliance personnel:** Support consistent handling, applicable requirements, confidentiality, and review of sensitive concerns.

Escalation path: Care Coordinator → Director of Client Success. The Director of Client Success is the escalation point and decision maker for all cases. For suspected abuse, neglect, or exploitation, the Care Coordinator reports to both the Director of Client Success and the Administrator at the same time.

4. Review before scheduling

Before scheduling a caregiver, the person in charge reviews the caregiver's forms, prior warnings, open action plans, follow-up evidence, and any restrictions or decisions from the Director of Client Success or the Administrator. Confirm that the caregiver is eligible for the proposed assignment. If eligibility is unclear or a restriction remains unresolved, obtain the Director of Client Success's decision before scheduling and record the decision in the restricted caregiver record.

5. When to use it

Complete a form when feedback requires a documented expectation, corrective action, or follow-up, including verified performance gaps, repeated concerns, or training needs. Appendix A provides examples. Training alone does not count as a strike.

Documentation target: Complete routine coaching documentation by the next business day after the discussion.

Follow-up target: Set the follow-up date before closing the coaching discussion and review evidence on that date. Immediate escalation requirements take priority.

Major offenses require immediate escalation

Once a major offense involving a caregiver is detected or suspected, the Care Coordinator must immediately escalate it to the Director of Client Success. If the concern involves suspected abuse, neglect, or exploitation, the Care Coordinator reports it immediately to both the Director of Client Success and the Administrator. Protect the client and activate the incident pathway as appropriate. Do not wait for a completed coaching form or apply the three-strike process.

Examples include abuse, neglect, exploitation, theft, falsification of care records, serious confidentiality breaches, abandonment, and conduct creating a serious safety risk. Separate allegations from verified findings. Record the facts, protective actions, notification time, and instructions received. Incident reporting and formal employment actions follow their separate agency procedures.

Minor offenses follow three strikes

A minor offense is a verified, lower-risk breach of an established expectation that does not meet the major-offense threshold. Record one strike per distinct verified event, with the supporting form. Unverified complaints do not count as strikes.

- **Strike 1 — Verbal warning:** Document the coaching, caregiver response, expected behavior, support, and follow-up date.
- **Strike 2 — Written warning:** Document a measurable corrective action plan and explain that a third strike requires review by the Director of Client Success.

- **Strike 3 — Final warning and escalation:** Document the third verified minor offense and refer the case to the Director of Client Success for a decision.

Whenever a case is reviewed, the Director of Client Success determines the outcome, which may include corrective action, conditional continued employment, or termination of employment, according to the facts and agency procedures. Conditional continued employment means a further opportunity to meet documented expectations, with specific conditions and follow-up. Three strikes do not automatically result in termination.

Confirm the method for tracking conditional continued employment, including the decision, the authorizing Director of Client Success, conditions, review date, outcome, and effect on the strike count. Do not assume prior strikes reset.

6. Where to find and complete the form

In WellSky, open the caregiver's profile and go to Caregiver Forms. Select the Major Offense Caregiver Counseling Form or Minor Offense Caregiver Counseling Form according to the case.

Enter the employee name and date. Select the warning type: verbal, written, or final warning, as applicable. Select the relevant offense types and describe the concern. Identify the people involved, record the employee's input, and complete the corrective action plan. Enter the date improvement is expected, add any additional notes, then sign and date the form.

7. How to use the form

Step 1. Review the facts. Check prior forms, relevant standards, evidence, and service impact. Classify the concern and escalate major offenses immediately.

Step 2. Discuss privately. Explain the facts, hear the caregiver's response, and document disagreements, barriers, and training needs. Distinguish observations from reports or allegations.

Step 3. Agree on the action plan. Define the expected behavior, caregiver actions, agency support, responsible person, deadline, success measure, and follow-up date.

Step 4. Review and acknowledge. Review the form with the caregiver and provide a copy through the approved channel. Acknowledgment confirms receipt, not agreement. Document any refusal and its date.

Step 5. Store the form. Store the form in the restricted record. Keep detailed client and personal information out of broadly visible registers.

Step 6. Follow up and close. Review evidence on the agreed date. Record achieved, partially achieved, or not achieved; document further action, closure, or escalation to the Director of Client Success.

8. Required form information

Caregiver name; coaching and event dates; coaching category; observed facts; source information; applicable legislation and service impact; caregiver explanation, including disagreement or relevant barriers; action plan; agency support; owner; deadline; success measure; follow-up date; acknowledgment or documented refusal; follow-up evidence; outcome; and closure or escalation decision.

9. Review and escalation

The person in charge reviews recurring patterns, overdue follow-ups, unresolved concerns, and improvement, using the full history and the caregiver's response. Care Coordinators escalate major offenses immediately, and third minor strikes, to the Director of Client Success, and report suspected abuse, neglect, or exploitation immediately to both the Director of Client Success and the Administrator. Refer disputed facts or unclear eligibility to the Director of Client Success for review. Record the reviewer's decision, responsible person, and next step. Before saving, confirm the form is factual, respectful, complete, and measurable.

Appendix A. Examples of when to use a coaching form

Use these examples as references. Select the response based on the facts, risk, and agency policy. Urgent safety concerns require immediate escalation before routine coaching.

Repeated lateness

Example: A caregiver arrives late for two shifts and relief coverage is delayed.

Response: Verify arrival records, discuss barriers, restate the call-in and punctuality expectations, and review attendance over the next two weeks.

Incomplete shift documentation

Example: Required shift notes repeatedly omit completed tasks.

Response: Review the documentation standard, provide a sample and training, and check the next five notes for completeness.

Missed handoff communication

Example: A caregiver does not communicate a relevant nonurgent update at shift change.

Response: Clarify the handoff process, practice the approved method, and verify the next four handoffs. Escalate immediately if the missed information creates a safety concern.

Care task or procedure gap

Example: A caregiver is uncertain about an assigned task or performs it inconsistently.

Response: Confirm the task is authorized and within the caregiver's role. Arrange instruction and competency verification before independent performance where needed.

Professional communication

Example: A verified interaction shows disrespectful language toward a coworker or client.

Response: Document the specific words or behavior, hear the caregiver's account, and set clear communication expectations. Refer serious threats to the Director of Client Success, and report abuse allegations to both the Director of Client Success and the Administrator.

Attendance failure or no call no show

Example: A caregiver misses a scheduled shift without required notice.

Response: Arrange coverage and confirm client safety first. Verify the circumstances, notify the Director of Client Success, and document the attendance review under agency policy.

Client complaint

Example: A client reports that an agreed routine was not followed.

Response: Record the report as a report, verify instructions and available facts, hear the caregiver's account, and document coaching if a performance gap is confirmed.

Immediate escalation example: A report of suspected abuse, neglect, or exploitation, or immediate danger, requires prompt protective action and the agency's incident pathway. The Care Coordinator reports it immediately to both the Director of Client Success and the Administrator. Record facts without prejudging the outcome; coaching is not the initial response.